



*Teaching
Genealogists AI™*
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Worksheet 4 — Alternative Source Strategy Planner & Negative Search Log

Course: Census Records for Puerto Rican Genealogy

Module: Module 9 — Handling Parish Access Limitations

Purpose: Plan substitute searches when a parish register is restricted or does not survive, and document every negative search as evidence for a reasonably exhaustive research process.

Researcher Information

Field	Entry
Researcher Name	
Date	
Ancestor(s) Being Researched	

Field	Entry
Municipality (<i>municipio</i>)	
Research Question	

Part 1 — Parish Access Assessment

Define exactly which parish record you need and confirm its access status before planning substitutes.

Field	Entry
Parish	
Diocese	
Record type needed (baptism / marriage / burial)	
Date range needed	
Digitized at FamilySearch? (Y / N / Partial — note year ranges)	
Access status (Available / Restricted / Lost / Unknown)	
Source of access status information	
Date status confirmed	

Part 2 — Alternative Source Strategy Planner

For each fact the parish record would have provided, identify the substitute records that could establish it. Use one row per alternative source.

Fact Needed	Alternative Record Type	Repository / Collection	URL	Evidence Expected (Direct / Indirect / Negative)	Search Status (Planned / Done / Found / Not Found)	Notes
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Common substitutes to consider: civil registration (1885 forward), federal census (1910–1950), municipal padrones, newspapers (*Chronicling America*), notarial and land records (AGPR), probate records, WWI/WWII draft registration cards.

Part 3 — Negative Search Log

Record every search that produced no result. This documentation is required for GPS compliance; negative searches define the limits of the surviving record base.

Date	Repository	Collection Searched	Date Range Searched	Search Terms Used	Reason No Result (Not in collection / Collection missing / Inaccessible / Other)	Citation / Note for Research File

Part 4 — Correlation Summary

When substitute records have been gathered, summarize how they combine to answer the research question.

Question	Answer
Which facts are now established, and by which combination of sources?	
Which facts remain unestablished after the alternative searches?	
Do any substitute sources conflict with each other? How will you resolve it?	
If parish access changes in the future, which register and date range should you revisit first?	

Next Steps

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.